

Handout 4.5: Greener Room Swap

Name: _____ Date: _____ Partner: _____

Directions: Part 1 and Part 2 fill in with the class. Part 3 is the swap: read the room, and for every item write a greener swap, the green factor it improves, and whether it is free, cheap (under \$25), or money. Then pick your top three.

Word bank in Spanish

English	Spanish
reduce	reducir
reuse	reutilizar
recycle	reciclar
compost	compost (abono)
secondhand	de segunda mano (usado)
natural light	luz natural
waste	desecho (basura)

Part 1: The four Rs and the five green factors

The four Rs	What it means at home	One example
Reduce		
Reuse		
Recycle		
Compost ("rot")		
Green factor in a living space		What makes it better
Natural light		
Materials		
Indoor air		
Water		
Waste		

Part 2: Sort the twelve

Write each item in one bin. Some could go in two; pick the one that does the least harm.

Items: a glass jar, a cardboard box, a banana peel, a plastic bag, a T-shirt with a hole, a phone charger that works, a chipped mug, a stack of junk mail, a pizza box with grease, a wooden chair with a loose leg, a plastic water bottle, coffee grounds

REDUCE (do not bring it in)	REUSE	RECYCLE	COMPOST

Part 3: The room

A teen's bedroom. The window has a broken blind that is stuck closed, so the lamp is on all day. The desk is particleboard and wobbles; the plan is to throw it out and buy another one like it for \$60. A can of aerosol air freshener sits on the dresser and gets sprayed every morning. Clothes and school things are stored in a set of six new plastic tubs bought last month. The bookshelf is a fast-furniture shelf that sagged in a year. A trash bag by the door holds clothes that do not fit anymore, headed for the curb. The radiator valve drips into a bucket that gets emptied every day. A fan runs all day, every day, with the door closed and the window shut.

#	The item	Greener swap	Green factor (light / materials / air / water / waste)	Free / cheap (under \$25) / money
1	Broken blind, lamp on all day			
2	Wobbly particleboard desk, replace with the same			
3	Aerosol air freshener every morning			
4	Six new plastic tubs			
5	Sagging fast- furniture bookshelf			
6	A bag of clothes			

	for the curb			
7	Radiator valve dripping into a bucket			
8	Fan all day, door and window shut			

Top three (most good for the least money), one sentence each on why:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Grade 8 stretch: Write two sentences to the landlord asking for the radiator valve to be fixed. Use the water and the money, not feelings.
